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Living Systems SEO & AEO Audit

Website: livingsystems.ca Audit date: Aug 21, 2026 Audience: Living Systems leadership, counselling and training teams, content owners, web administrators and agency partners

This audit applies the SEO and AEO audit framework to the new Living Systems website, combining technical crawl evidence, first-party search and engagement data, public-page review, and an authenticated read-only review of WordPress plugins and settings.

Executive Summary

Living Systems has a credible organic foundation: the new site publishes substantial Bowen family systems content, organic visitors engage more deeply than most other channels, and early AI-assistant traffic is small but high quality. The main limitation is not a lack of expertise or useful material. It is operational search hygiene: global broken links, over-indexed archives, incomplete entity data, inconsistent metadata and headings, and weak conversion measurement.

Semrush crawled 169 URLs and reported 86% Site Health, but found 138 errors and 343 warnings. The most damaging defects are 120 broken internal links, nine 4xx pages, 42 orphaned sitemap pages, 28 missing meta descriptions, duplicate descriptions, and many non-descriptive or empty anchors. Several problems are template- or settings-driven, so correcting them once will improve many pages at the same time.

First-party data from GA4 shows strong demand. In the latest 28-day period, Search Console recorded 38,531 impressions and 316 clicks. Organic search generated 483 sessions, a 60.25% engagement rate and 1 minute 14 seconds of average engagement time per session. Yet the traffic-acquisition report recorded zero key events, so the site cannot currently connect search visibility to counselling inquiries, training interest or donations with confidence.

Decision: work on indexation and measurement first, finish the Yoast and Local SEO configuration, then turn the strongest informational pages into a connected Bowen-theory and service ecosystem with answer-first summaries, clear authorship and review signals, and stronger calls to action. This is the fastest path to more non-branded discovery and more reliable eligibility for search and answer-engine citations.

Key audit indicators

Key audit indicators establish a baseline for evaluating overall technical health and engagement metrics. Establishing transparent metrics allows search engines and discovery algorithms to track structural reliability and performance improvements over time.

Semrush Site Health 86%

Internal broken links 120

Orphaned sitemap pages 42

Search Console impressions / clicks 38,531 / 316

Organic sessions / engagement rate 483 / 60.25%

AI-assistant sessions / engagement rate 29 / 72.41%

GA4 key events in acquisition report 0

Top five actions

Focusing on high-impact steps helps with efficient resource allocation for technical SEO and AEO optimizations. Resolving foundation defects first maximizes crawl efficiency and establishes authoritative entity signals for search engines.

1. Repair the global broken-link patterns and create a verified redirect map. Correct the repeated /donation_form/ and newsletter links, restore or redirect the remaining 4xx targets, and retest the 404 report.
2. Complete Yoast site representation and Local SEO settings. Set the organization logo explicitly; correct legal name and description; add verified address, phone, email, country, postal code, service area and time zone; and remove the default seven-day opening-hours output unless it is accurate.
3. Reduce index bloat and snippet defects. Noindex or retire low-value author, tag, test, placeholder and unused custom-post-type archives; resolve 42 sitemap orphans; add missing descriptions; and normalize one descriptive H1 per indexable page.
4. Build an answer-first content and internal-linking system around counselling, training, Bowen theory and high-impression resources. Prioritize the emotional-pain and helpful-help pages, where impressions are already high but click-through rates are low.
5. Make measurement and site operations dependable. Define GA4 key events for counselling intake, training registration, phone/email clicks and donations; configure

backups and a recovery point; stage pending updates; and adopt a light publishing and change-log governance routine.

Scope and Method

The audit covered hosting and delivery, HTTPS, crawl status, redirects, XML-sitemap quality, canonicalization, metadata, heading semantics, internal links, content and query demand, structured data, local entity clarity, images and accessibility, analytics, AEO readiness, and WordPress plugin configuration. Evidence came from a mobile JavaScript-enabled Semrush crawl, Semrush Canada domain and AI visibility reports, GA4, Search Console, rendered public pages, and the authenticated WordPress administration area.

No website, analytics or plugin settings were changed.

Current-State Scorecard

The Current-State Scorecard provides a standardized benchmark across critical technical and content pillars. Measuring functional capabilities highlights key operational gaps that directly influence organic rank and answer engine citations.

The SEO foundation score is 58/100 and the AEO readiness score is 58/100. These metrics serve as tools for prioritization. Performance and subject-matter depth are the strongest assets; technical hygiene, local entity data, internal linking and measurement are the largest controllable gaps.

SEO foundation: credible content, incomplete operational controls

A solid technical SEO foundation ensures that search engines can accurately discover, crawl, and index website assets. Fixing structural and metadata defects avoids index bloat and improves organic ranking potential.

Performance and delivery — 78/100. Semrush performance is 95%; dynamic caching is enabled; frontend optimization and object caching remain unconfigured.

Content and query coverage — 68/100. Strong Bowen-theory resources earn impressions and engagement, but service-intent and training pathways need a clearer search architecture.

Crawl and index hygiene — 55/100. Crawlability is 96%, but 4xx pages, repeated broken links, redirects and orphaned archives dilute the estate.

Metadata and headings — 58/100. Priority service pages are generally sound; 28 pages lack descriptions, nine descriptions duplicate, 11 titles are long, and eight pages have multiple H1s.

Structured data and entity clarity — 52/100. Yoast emits a connected graph, but Local SEO is essentially blank and organization fields contain errors or defaults.

Architecture and internal links — 50/100. The main navigation is useful, but 147 non-descriptive anchors, 83 links without anchor text, 54 weakly linked pages and 42 orphans constrain discovery.

Authority and local discovery — 55/100. Authority Score is 22 with 187 referring domains; Semrush flags 42 of 47 local listings for correction.

Analytics and governance — 44/100. GA4 and Search Console are available, but no key events appear in the acquisition report and operational plugin controls are incomplete.

AEO readiness: useful answers, uneven extraction and entity signals

Trust / E-E-A-T — 4/5. The nonprofit history, counsellor and faculty pages, contact details, charitable registration and deep theory content support trust.

Summarizability — 3/5. Several pages answer questions well, but concise answer-first leads are inconsistent.

Definitional sentences — 3/5. Bowen concepts are explained, though important pages often open with broad positioning rather than a direct definition.

Citability — 3/5. Detailed resources exist, but review dates, named content owners and source notes are not systematic.

Query coverage — 3/5. Branded and informational demand is visible; service-intent, location and training-use-case coverage is thinner.

Internal linking — 2/5. Orphans, empty anchors and repeated generic labels weaken graph clarity.

Entity clarity — 3/5. The brand and Bowen focus are visible, but local business details and organization schema are incomplete.

Snippet and social strength — 3/5. Key pages have strong titles and descriptions; homepage social title is only “Home,” and gaps remain elsewhere.

Freshness and index hygiene — 2/5. Test pages, placeholder archives and stale event content remain discoverable.

Schema depth — 3/5. Core Yoast schema is present; accurate local, event, course and profile details need configuration and page-level discipline.

Key Findings

The Key Findings section details granular performance evaluations across infrastructure, content, and architecture. Documenting specific technical vulnerabilities provides the actionable roadmap required to optimize for search crawlers and generative AI platforms.

1. Hosting, security and performance

Optimal hosting speed and secure delivery improve user retention and meet critical Page Experience guidelines. Strong performance indicators prevent crawl budget exhaustion and directly influence mobile search visibility.

The public delivery baseline is sound. Semrush reports 98% HTTPS health and 95% site performance. WordPress Speed Optimizer has Dynamic Caching and Automatic Purge enabled, while browser-specific caching is correctly off.

The optimization stack is only partially configured. Speed Optimizer has CSS, JavaScript and HTML minification, JavaScript deferral, font optimization, WebP, its own lazy loading and Memcached turned off. Semrush correspondingly flags 131 unminified JavaScript/CSS issues and 130 low text-to-HTML ratios. These are opportunities, not recommendations to enable every switch at once: Elementor, JetEngine, Contact Form 7 and analytics scripts must be tested on staging.

Smush is already performing automatic compression, metadata removal and lazy loading for core page types and common media types. Speed Optimizer image compression is also enabled, creating an overlap that should be corrected. Keep one owner for compression and one for lazy loading; do not layer a second optimization path without before/after image-quality and performance tests.

WordPress Site Health reports four recommended improvements: remove inactive plugins, remove inactive themes, enable an opcode cache and use a persistent object cache. Five updates are pending, including a Yoast Premium version mismatch and updates for Elementor Pro and JetEngine. Stage and back up before applying the updates, then test navigation, filters, forms, schema, analytics and mobile rendering.

Security Optimizer is installed but inactive. Activate it only after confirming the SiteGround hosting controls and staging compatibility, or document the alternative WAF/host-security controls in use. No SEO plugin should be added to solve security. Treat HSTS, content security policy, login protection and update governance as platform-hardening work with regression tests.

2. Crawling, redirects and indexation

Clean crawling pathways and accurate canonical redirects ensure search spiders process valid pages without disruption. Fixing broken links and orphaned URLs consolidates link equity and maximizes indexing efficiency.

Semrush crawled 169 URLs. Nine pages return 4xx, and 120 internal links point to broken targets. The most important pattern is systemic: many posts link to the misspelled `/dontation_form/` and to `/living-systems-newsletter-signup/`, so a single template or reusable-content repair can eliminate much of the error count. Other broken targets include removed articles, an old affordable-counselling path, a past conference and a legacy training query URL.

The site also carries 97 permanently redirected URLs, 34 URLs containing underscores, 42 sitemap-orphan pages, eight pages more than three clicks deep and 54 pages with only one incoming internal link. The contact page currently resolves at `/contact_us/`, while `/contact/` redirects and `/contact-us/` returns 404. Keep the current canonical only if leadership prefers it; otherwise normalize high-value slugs once, with a tested one-hop redirect map and updated internal links.

Orphans include author archives, category and tag archives, banner-message and event content types, placeholder events, an HTML verification page, legacy learning/team pages, a KML location sitemap and test content. Decide the intended search role of each content type. Keep only pages with a clear audience, unique content and internal-link path; noindex or remove the rest and exclude them from XML sitemaps.

Priority 4xx targets

`/?post_type=training&p=13308` — replace with the canonical training page or restore the intended item.

`/dontation_form/` — correct the reusable link to the valid donation destination and retain a redirect for external or legacy traffic.

`/living-systems-newsletter-signup/` — restore a valid signup destination or remove the sitewide call to action.

`/be-a-better-observer/`, `/expectations-and-emotional-demands/`, `/the-power-of-anxiety-binding/` and `/resources/elevator-systems-podcast/` — redirect only where a true topical successor exists; otherwise remove the links.

`/education/conferences/fall-2025-conference-on-aging/` and the legacy affordable-counselling path — map to an active archive or current service page only when user intent is preserved.

3. Metadata, headings and language

Metadata and HTML heading semantics accurately communicate page hierarchy and intent to search crawlers. Consistent title tags, meta descriptions, and clean H1 structures improve search result click-through rates and answer extraction accuracy.

Priority service pages show good work: the homepage, counselling, training, about, contact and crisis-resources pages have descriptive titles, unique descriptions and self-canonical tags. The document language is en-CA. However, the homepage Open Graph title is only “Home,” the Open Graph locale remains en_US, and the WebSite schema description is “site logo,” so social and entity snippets are not fully aligned with the visible brand.

Across the crawl, 28 pages lack meta descriptions, nine pages share duplicate descriptions and 11 titles are overly long. Missing descriptions concentrate in conferences, presentations, team profiles and training entries. Duplicate descriptions occur on several podcast episodes, a test page and training items. Use page-type defaults only as a fallback; write editorial descriptions for priority pages and remove test content from the index.

Eight pages have more than one H1, including Emotional Pain and Suffering, which has three H1 elements. Another page has an H1 that duplicates its title, and the homepage contains empty H2 elements plus the typo “Quick Llnks.” Enforce one descriptive H1 and a sequential H2/H3 hierarchy in Elementor templates and dynamic listings, while keeping visual styles independent of semantic levels.

4. Architecture and internal linking

Logical site architecture and intentional internal linking distribute page authority and clarify topical relationships across pages. Descriptive anchor text guides crawlers and AI agents to relevant destination hubs efficiently.

The main journeys—counselling, training, about Bowen theory, resources, news and contact—are visible, but the internal graph is noisy. Semrush found 147 non-descriptive anchors and 83 links without anchor text. Replace generic labels such as “Read More” with concise destination-specific text, and ensure cards expose one accessible, descriptive link rather than stacked empty overlay links.

Create four hubs: Counselling, Training, Bowen Family Systems Theory, and Resources/Insights. Each hub should link to its core subtopics and receive contextual links back from articles, practitioner profiles, conference pages and FAQs. The goal is not more navigation items; it is clearer relationships among services, concepts, audiences and next actions.

Preserve useful redirects such as the old Bowen-theory path resolving to About only if the destination fully satisfies the query. Where a redirect hides a distinct search intent, create a

dedicated evergreen page instead. Add a related-content block that uses editorially controlled anchor text and excludes test, expired and placeholder content types.

5. Structured data, entity and local clarity

Structured data markup provides explicit machine-readable context about organization entities, locations, and services. Accurate schema implementation strengthens local knowledge graph connections and enhances search snippet eligibility.

Yeast currently shows WebPage, WebSite, BreadcrumbList, ImageObject and Organization/Place nodes, and Semrush reports 100% markup health. The graph is structurally connected, but several values are inaccurate or incomplete. The Organization description contains “afforadble,” the legal name has inconsistent capitalization, the phone is absent from schema despite appearing in the footer, and the logo is being used as a fallback rather than an explicitly saved organization logo.

The Local SEO plugin is installed but Business info is essentially blank: business type remains generic Organization, and address, city, province, postal code, country, coordinates, phone, email, price indication, area served and time zone are empty. Default 9:00–17:00 hours for every day are present and appear in the homepage graph. Verify real public/office hours or suppress opening-hours output; never publish defaults as facts.

Complete Site representation first, then Local SEO. Use the verified legal organization name, an accessible brand logo, the public North Vancouver address if it is a true customer-facing location, phone, email, service area, Canadian address format and correct time zone. Select the closest supported business type without overstating clinical status, and keep visible contact details synchronized with schema and external listings.

Do not add another schema plugin. Yoast SEO, Premium and Local SEO already provide the connected graph, redirects, XML sitemaps and content controls required. Adding a parallel schema plugin would increase duplicate-node and conflicting-value risk. Configure the existing graph, validate it, and use page-level schema only where visible content supports it.

6. Content, organic demand and AEO

High-quality, answer-first content addresses user search intent and aligns with AI answer extraction requirements. Structuring informative content with direct definitions boosts eligibility for AI overview citations and organic search features.

Semrush Canada estimates 302 monthly organic visits, 96 ranking keywords, Authority Score 22, 187 referring domains and 707 backlinks. The homepage represents 69.2% of estimated organic traffic; “What Kind of Help Is Helpful?” and “Emotional Pain and Suffering” are the next strongest

pages. This concentration is an opportunity: the site already has evidence that deep educational content can attract discovery beyond the brand.

Search Console recorded 316 clicks and 38,531 impressions in the latest 28-day period, with average CTR of 0.82% and average position 9.98. Emotional Pain and Suffering generated 20,942 impressions—more than half of the total—but only 0.23% CTR. What Kind of Help Is Helpful generated 4,969 impressions and 0.12% CTR. These pages are high-priority snippet and intent-alignment opportunities, not candidates for wholesale rewrites that risk losing relevance.

Query data is brand-heavy: approximately 65% of clicks came from Living Systems brand variants. Non-branded demand appears around pain versus suffering, Bowen family systems theory and emotional pain. Build clear definitions, concise answer-first leads, related Bowen concepts, practitioner-reviewed source notes and contextual service links without turning educational pages into aggressive sales copy.

AI-assistant referrals generated 29 sessions with a 72.41% engagement rate and 57 seconds average engagement time per session. Semrush Canada reports three AI mentions and five cited pages. The sample is small but promising. Google states that AI features use normal indexed pages, and OpenAI recommends allowing OAI-SearchBot for discovery; Living Systems does not need a special “AI SEO” plugin or invented markup.

Reusable answer-engine content pattern

1. Open with a 40–80-word answer that defines the topic, states the page scope and avoids unsupported clinical outcomes.
2. Use question-shaped H2s followed by a direct one- or two-sentence answer before supporting detail.
3. Connect each concept to stable related entities: Bowen theory, differentiation, triangles, family-of-origin work, counselling, training, counsellor or faculty profiles, and cited sources.
4. Add a visible reviewer or content owner and last-reviewed date on theory, counselling, crisis and professional-training content.
5. Use concise comparisons or definitions only where they improve understanding; do not manufacture FAQ content merely to add schema.
6. End with relevant next-step links: learn the theory, explore counselling, meet the team, review training, contact Living Systems, or use crisis resources when appropriate.

7. Authority, local discovery and trust

Establishing off-page authority and consistent local information builds brand trust across digital channels. Synchronized business details and credible external references validate E-E-A-T signals for search and answer engines.

Living Systems has a modest but credible off-page base. Improve authority by making practitioner and faculty profiles more useful to humans and machines: full names, roles, qualifications, practice or teaching focus, professional affiliations where approved, and links to authored or reviewed resources. Avoid implying credentials, specialties or outcomes that are not verified.

Semrush Listing Management rates local listings “Bad” and reports 42 of 47 listings needing correction. Reconcile the canonical organization name, address, phone, website and category with the verified site and Google Business Profile. Use the same source-of-truth fields in Yoast Local SEO, the footer, contact page and directory profiles.

Create link-worthy assets that fit the organization’s mission: plain-language Bowen theory explainers, family systems glossaries, training syllabi and event resources, crisis-resource references, and practitioner-reviewed guides. Focus outreach on universities, professional associations, community organizations and relevant podcasts rather than generic directory volume.

8. Images and accessibility

Proper image optimization and accessibility compliance improve usability and satisfy core visual search requirements. Descriptive image alt attributes and responsive media delivery ensure fast loading speeds and good user experience.

The homepage includes images without explicit dimensions and several empty links created by the Elementor structure. The site logo alt text is a long geometric description—“Three overlapping geometric circles...”—rather than an appropriate brand label or intentionally empty decorative alternative. Use “Living Systems” when the logo functions as the home link; use empty alt only when an image is genuinely decorative.

Semrush found many non-descriptive and anchorless links. W3C guidance requires link purpose to be understandable in context, descriptive headings, and text alternatives for meaningful images. Repair card accessible names, keyboard focus, form labels, error messages, contrast, empty headings and the “Quick Links” typo during the same template QA cycle. This audit identifies risks but is not a WCAG conformance test.

Smush lazy loading applies to core pages and posts but excludes custom post types such as events, team members and training. Review real above-the-fold behaviour and image dimensions

before broadening it. Exclude the logo and primary hero image from lazy loading when needed to protect Largest Contentful Paint and visual stability.

9. Analytics and measurement

Accurate event tracking and conversion measurement establish reliable feedback loops for evaluating organic strategy performance. Setting up key events allows organizations to tie search visibility directly to real-world engagement outcomes.

GA4 reports approximately 1,531 sessions in the latest 28-day period. Direct accounts for 59.31%, organic search 31.55%, referral 4.25%, organic social 2.55% and AI assistants 1.89%. Organic sessions have stronger engagement than direct traffic: 60.25% engagement and 1 minute 14 seconds average engagement time per session.

The acquisition report shows zero key events for every channel. The GA4 home view reports 17 key events across 90 days, down 55.3%, which indicates an inconsistent or incomplete conversion setup rather than a dependable business outcome view. Define a small event model, mark the business-critical events as key events, and verify them in DebugView and live reports.

Track counselling-intake CTA clicks, successful Contact Form 7 submissions, phone and email clicks, Google Form outbound starts, training registration clicks or completions, donation starts/completions and crisis-resource clicks as separate events. If forms or payments live on external domains, configure cross-domain or outbound measurement and avoid treating a mere page view as a completed inquiry.

The 404 page recorded 183 views in the latest 28-day period, making it the fourth most-viewed page title. Add a GA4 404 event with page location and referrer, and use the resulting report with Semrush to repair internal links and high-value external entry paths.

Keep GA4 and Search Console as the first-party source of truth; use Semrush for prioritization and directional competitive estimates.

10. WordPress plugins and settings

Streamlining active plugins reduces system overhead and eliminates technical conflicts that degrade site health. Maintaining a lean WordPress stack protects security, speeds up rendering, and prevents duplicate schema output.

The site has 22 installed plugins: 19 active and three inactive. Auto-updates are disabled on the plugin list, five updates are pending, and Site Health recommends removing inactive plugins. The goal is a smaller, clearly owned stack—not more overlapping tools.

SEO and search controls

Keep Yoast SEO 28.3, Yoast SEO Premium and Yoast Local SEO, but update Premium from 28.2 to match the free plugin and complete first-time configuration. Review the newly added Training, Events, Team Members, Presentation and public-presentations search-appearance settings. All custom post types and their archives are currently indexable; author archives, categories, tags, training categories and public presentations are also indexable. Keep only archives that have unique value and intentional internal links.

Delete inactive SmartCrawl Pro after confirming no legacy sitemap, redirect or schema dependency remains. Do not add Redirection, a second sitemap plugin or another schema plugin: Yoast Premium already supplies redirects and the current Yoast stack owns titles, schema, robots directives and XML sitemaps.

Caching and media

Keep Speed Optimizer as the server-caching owner. Pilot Memcached and selective frontend optimization on staging, beginning with one change per test. Keep Smush only if it remains the chosen image-compression and lazy-load owner; otherwise migrate those settings to Speed Optimizer and remove Smush after validating image quality, WebP delivery, exclusions and performance. Avoid double compression and double lazy loading.

Backups, security and updates

Duplicator Pro is active, but no backups have ever been created, no schedules are enabled and no recovery point exists. Either configure encrypted offsite scheduled backups with a tested restore/recovery point, or document the host backup policy and remove Duplicator if it is redundant. A backup plugin that is installed but idle does not reduce risk.

Security Optimizer is inactive. Stage and activate it if SiteGround hosting is the agreed security owner and its controls are compatible; otherwise remove it and document the alternative. Apply core, theme and plugin updates on staging after a fresh backup, then run smoke tests for Elementor templates, JetEngine listings/filters, Contact Form 7, redirects, schema, GA4 and mobile navigation.

Editorial and import utilities

Bulk Datetime Change, Media Sync, WordPress Importer and WP All Import should be active only during a controlled migration or scheduled job. If no recurring import depends on them, deactivate and retain only the tools needed for a defined workflow; delete those with no owner. Keep Duplicate Page only for authorized editors and require an explicit noindex/draft review so clones do not enter the sitemap.

Contact Form 7 is appropriate if active site forms depend on it. Audit the actual form inventory, spam protection, delivery, privacy copy, success events and retention. If all intake is now routed to Google Forms and no CF7 forms remain, deactivate it after confirming no template or workflow dependency.

Recommended additional plugin—conditional

If multiple staff and agency users continue to edit the site, add one lightweight administrative activity log such as Simple History. It can record content, user, plugin and settings changes and defaults to 60-day retention. Configure role access, IP anonymization, retention and privacy procedures before enabling it. Do not install it if the host or managed service already provides an equivalent, reviewed audit trail.

Plugin disposition summary

Keep and configure: Yoast SEO, Yoast Premium, Yoast Local, Speed Optimizer, Elementor/Pro, JetEngine, JetSmartFilters, Site Kit, Microsoft Clarity and the form tool actually in use.

Consolidate: Smush versus Speed Optimizer media features; Duplicator versus documented host backups.

Update and test: WordPress core, Elementor Pro, JetEngine and Yoast Premium, plus any remaining pending updates.

Deactivate when idle: Bulk Datetime Change, Media Sync, WordPress Importer and WP All Import.

Remove after dependency check: inactive SmartCrawl Pro, unused inactive Post Views Counter, unused themes and abandoned utilities.

Conditional add: Simple History only when a shared-editor audit trail is not already available.

Implementation-Ready Page Blueprints

Page blueprints provide actionable content and metadata templates tailored to target key search queries. Deploying optimized headings, descriptions, and answer summaries directly improves snippet rendering and user CTR.

The copy below is a draft optimized for clarity, search snippets and answer extraction. Living Systems should review counselling, training, practitioner and crisis language for factual accuracy, professional standards, accessibility and brand voice before publication.

Homepage /

The homepage serves as the primary brand authority hub and entry point for domain link equity. Aligning homepage metadata with core organizational identity strengthens broad brand recognition and topic relevance.

Proposed SEO title: Bowen Family Systems Counselling & Training | Living Systems

Proposed meta description: Explore Bowen family systems counselling, training and practical resources from Living Systems, a Canadian nonprofit serving individuals, families and professionals.

Proposed H1: Bowen Family Systems Counselling and Training

Proposed lead: Living Systems helps people and professionals understand relationship patterns through Bowen family systems theory. Explore counselling, training, practitioner-reviewed resources and upcoming learning opportunities in Metro Vancouver and online where available.

Replace the social title “Home,” add concise text links to Counselling, Training, Learn Bowen Theory, Meet the Team and Contact, and expose the organization’s verified nonprofit identity and service area above the fold.

Counselling /counselling/

Optimizing commercial service pages captures high-intent local and regional search queries. Clear service offerings paired with targeted call-to-action paths convert organic traffic into inquiries efficiently.

Proposed SEO title: Family Systems Counselling for Individuals, Couples & Families

Proposed meta description: Explore Bowen family systems counselling for individuals, couples and families. Learn how sessions work, meet the team and ask about sliding-fee options.

Proposed H1: Family Systems Counselling at Living Systems

Proposed lead: Family systems counselling looks at how patterns of connection, stress and reactivity operate within important relationships. Living Systems works with individuals, couples and families and offers a no-obligation inquiry to help determine whether the approach fits their needs.

Keep the existing team, session and FAQ modules. Add a short “Is this right for me?” answer, explain sliding-fee eligibility without promising availability, and track intake CTA clicks and successful inquiries.

Bowen theory /about/ or a dedicated evergreen URL

Dedicated educational hubs position the organization as a topical authority on specialized domain subjects. Thorough conceptual explanations increase eligibility for informative search queries and AI system citations.

Proposed SEO title: What Is Bowen Family Systems Theory? | Living Systems

Proposed meta description: Learn the core ideas of Bowen family systems theory, including differentiation, triangles and multigenerational patterns, with resources from Living Systems.

Proposed H1: What Is Bowen Family Systems Theory?

Proposed lead: Bowen family systems theory is a way of understanding how people influence one another within emotional relationship systems. It examines patterns such as differentiation, triangles, anxiety and multigenerational processes to support more thoughtful observation and response.

Choose one canonical theory URL. If About must continue to carry the theory content, make the title, H1, breadcrumb and internal anchors consistently theory-focused; otherwise create a dedicated theory hub and keep About focused on the organization.

Emotional Pain and Suffering /emotional-pain-and-suffering/

High-impression informational pages offer significant potential for boosting organic traffic through snippet refinement. Structuring content with single H1 tags and clear direct definitions improves CTR for non-branded queries.

Proposed SEO title: Emotional Pain vs. Suffering: A Systems Perspective

Proposed meta description: Explore the difference between emotional pain and suffering, how stories and reactivity can intensify distress, and how a systems perspective may help.

Proposed H1: Emotional Pain and Suffering

Proposed lead: Emotional pain is a real response to loss, conflict, disappointment or change. Emotional suffering can grow when interpretations, relationship patterns and repeated reactions intensify that pain. A systems perspective separates what happened from the patterns that follow, without minimizing the experience.

Preserve the page's strong topical depth, but reduce the three H1s to one, add a reviewer and review date, improve the title/snippet proposition, and link to differentiation, counselling and crisis resources with context-appropriate language.

What Kind of Help Is Helpful? /what-kind-of-help-is-helpful/

Addressing specific user questions with structured answers optimizes content for conversational search and AEO. Writing concise lead paragraphs captures featured snippet placements and assists generative answer engines.

Proposed SEO title: What Kind of Help Is Helpful? A Family Systems View

Proposed meta description: Learn how overfunctioning, anxiety and responsibility can shape helping relationships—and what non-anxious, respectful support may look like.

Proposed H1: What Kind of Help Is Helpful?

Proposed lead: Help is most useful when it respects another person's capacity and keeps responsibility clear. From a family systems perspective, anxious helping can become overfunctioning: doing more for someone in ways that may unintentionally reinforce dependence or reactivity.

This page has high impressions, very low CTR and no meta description. Add the description first, sharpen the opening definition, preserve the strongest examples, and connect the page to overfunctioning, differentiation, counselling and training resources.

Training /training-2/

Structuring training programs with clear prerequisites and outcomes satisfies professional and educational search intent. Utilizing proper event or course metadata highlights schedule details directly in search engine results pages.

Proposed SEO title: Bowen Family Systems Theory Training in Canada | Living Systems

Proposed meta description: Explore Bowen theory training for clinicians, ministry leaders and other learners, including introductory and advanced programs from Living Systems.

Proposed H1: Bowen Family Systems Theory Training

Proposed lead: Living Systems offers Bowen family systems theory training for clinicians, ministry leaders and other learners who want a more thoughtful way to understand relationships, anxiety and leadership. Compare pathways, prerequisites, formats and upcoming dates.

Use Course or Event schema only when the visible program or event content supports every field. Give each substantial program a stable page with audience, learning objectives, instructors, prerequisites, delivery format, dates or cadence, fees and a clear registration action.

Contact /contact_us/

Contact pages provide essential NAP (Name, Address, Phone) data necessary for local search validation. Consolidating contact paths into a single canonical URL prevents duplicate indexation and solidifies local entity trust.

Proposed SEO title: Contact Living Systems Counselling & Training

Proposed meta description: Contact Living Systems about counselling, Bowen theory training, events or general questions. Find phone, email, address and inquiry options.

Proposed H1: How Can We Help?

Proposed lead: Contact Living Systems for counselling inquiries, training questions, event information or general support. Living Systems is not a crisis service; use the crisis-resources page for urgent and emergency contacts.

Keep one canonical slug and redirect all variants in one hop. Show the same verified name, address, phone, email and service-area information used in Yoast Local SEO and external listings. Track phone, email and inquiry-form actions separately.

Recommended Next Steps

The roadmap prioritizes template and platform corrections before broad content production. “Done when” criteria are intentionally testable so the team can separate completed work from activity.

0–30 days: stabilize the estate

Immediate remediation focuses on resolving critical indexation errors, broken links, and missing analytics events. Eliminating severe technical blockages prevents ongoing loss of crawl equity and ensures data collection accuracy.

P0 — Broken links and redirects. Owner: web administrator + content. Impact: High. Effort: Low. Confidence: High. Done when: all nine 4xx targets have an approved restore/remove/redirect decision; reusable donation/newsletter links are fixed; Semrush reports no internal 4xx links.

P0 — Yoast entity and Local SEO. Owner: SEO + organization administrator. Impact: High. Effort: Low. Confidence: High. Done when: name, logo, legal name, description, address, phone, email, country, postal code, service area, time zone and verified hours are saved and validated in the rendered graph.

P0 — Index inventory. Owner: SEO + content. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: every author, taxonomy, archive, CPT and test page is classified Keep / Improve / Noindex / Redirect / Remove; sitemaps contain only intentional canonical pages.

P0 — Measurement baseline. Owner: analytics + web. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: counselling, training, contact, donation and 404 events are validated; business-critical events are marked as key events; GA4 and Search Console owners are documented.

P0 — Recovery and updates. Owner: web administrator. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: an offsite backup and recovery point exist; a restore test is documented; pending updates pass staging smoke tests before production.

31–60 days: repair templates and priority pages

P1 — Metadata and headings. Owner: SEO + content + Elementor developer. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: zero missing descriptions on indexable priority pages; no duplicate H1/title template defect; one H1 and sequential headings on audited templates.

P1 — Internal linking. Owner: content + web. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: empty and generic anchors are reduced materially; 42 orphans have intentional links or are removed from the index; priority pages are within three clicks.

P1 — High-impression pages. Owner: content + subject reviewer. Impact: High. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: Emotional Pain and Suffering and What Kind of Help Is Helpful have revised snippets, one H1, answer-first leads, reviewer/date signals and contextual service/theory links.

P1 — Performance pilot. Owner: web administrator. Impact: Medium. Effort: Medium. Confidence: Medium. Done when: the team chooses one image/lazy-load owner, pilots object caching and selected minification/deferral changes on staging, and records no regression in forms, filters, analytics or mobile rendering.

61–90 days: expand durable discovery

P2 — Bowen theory hub. Owner: content + training/clinical reviewers. Impact: High. Effort: High. Confidence: High. Done when: one canonical theory hub links core concepts, practitioner-reviewed articles, counselling and training pathways with clear ownership and review cadence.

P2 — Service and training architecture. Owner: SEO + content. Impact: High. Effort: High. Confidence: Medium. Done when: counselling audiences and training programs have stable intent-specific pages, unique snippets, structured internal links and measured calls to action.

P2 — Local consistency. Owner: organization administrator + SEO. Impact: Medium. Effort: Medium. Confidence: High. Done when: verified NAP and categories match across the website, Google Business Profile and priority directories; listing errors are materially reduced.

P2 — Publishing governance. Owner: leadership + content. Impact: Medium. Effort: Low. Confidence: High. Done when: every high-trust page has an owner, reviewer where needed, last-reviewed date, review interval and retirement rule.

Measurement and Governance

Establishing continuous analytics monitoring and governance procedures guarantees ongoing SEO compliance. Routine tracking allows teams to adapt to algorithm shifts and verify long-term engagement growth.

Use first-party data to measure outcomes. Semrush is useful for crawl management and directional visibility, but Search Console and GA4 should establish baselines, release annotations, landing-page cohorts and conversions. Compare equivalent periods and account for seasonality, program dates and campaigns.

Measurement plan

Defining key performance indicators across search console and analytics platforms measures optimization ROI accurately. Tracking click-through rates, crawl errors, and conversion key events provides objective proof of strategic progress.

Non-branded organic clicks — Baseline: create a branded/non-branded query cohort from Search Console. 90-day target: positive growth without loss of branded demand. System: Search Console. Cadence: monthly.

High-impression page CTR — Baseline: Emotional Pain 0.23%; Helpful Help 0.12%. 90-day target: directional CTR improvement with stable or better average position. System: Search Console. Cadence: biweekly after changes.

Counselling inquiry key events — Baseline: 0 in channel acquisition. 90-day target: validated event capture and a stable conversion-rate baseline by source/medium and landing-page cohort. System: GA4 + form/outbound tracking. Cadence: weekly QA, monthly reporting.

Training interest key events — Baseline: not reliably measured. 90-day target: program and registration CTA events with landing-page attribution. System: GA4. Cadence: monthly and per program launch.

Crawl health — Baseline: 138 errors, 343 warnings, 120 broken internal links, 42 sitemap orphans. 90-day target: zero internal 4xx links, zero unclassified orphans and materially fewer warnings. System: Semrush Site Audit. Cadence: weekly during remediation, monthly thereafter.

404 demand — Baseline: 183 page views in the latest 28-day period. 90-day target: sustained reduction and no high-volume entry path without a redirect/content decision. System: GA4 404 event + Semrush. Cadence: weekly.

AI referral quality — Baseline: 29 sessions, 72.41% engagement. 90-day target: grow qualified sessions and observe cited/landing pages without sacrificing engagement. System: GA4 source cohort + Semrush AI visibility. Cadence: monthly.

Local consistency — Baseline: 42 of 47 listings flagged. 90-day target: verified NAP/category consistency on priority platforms. System: listing audit + manual verification. Cadence: monthly until stable.

Publishing governance

Assigning clear ownership for content creation, technical updates, and expert review maintains strong E-E-A-T signals over time. Structured editorial workflows ensure content remains accurate, fresh, and compliant with search standards.

- Leadership: approve organization name, legal identity, service area, claims and review-accountability model.
- Web administrator: own backups, staging, updates, redirects, sitemaps, caching, security controls and technical release checks.
- SEO/content: own query mapping, titles/descriptions, internal links, archive decisions, Search Console cohorts and content briefs.
- Counselling and training reviewers: validate theory, service, practitioner, crisis and program claims before publication and on a defined cadence.
- Analytics owner: maintain GA4 key events, consent/privacy alignment, cross-domain tracking, release annotations and monthly outcome reporting.
- Editors and agencies: use draft/noindex for cloned or imported content, record material changes, and retire expired events and test pages promptly.

Every indexable high-trust page should have a clear owner, an appropriate reviewer, a visible or recorded last-reviewed date, and a review or retirement rule. Events and dated programs should leave the sitemap or redirect only after a business-approved lifecycle decision.

Further Questions

Identifying open operational and technical questions resolves ambiguities prior to executing optimizations. Clarifying local business details and content ownership prevents inaccurate schema deployment and content inaccuracies.

1. What is the exact legal organization name, and which public name should appear in schema, the footer, donation records and directory profiles?
2. Is the North Vancouver address a customer-facing location, an administrative office or a mailing address, and what service area should Local SEO publish?
3. What are the verified public/office hours? If there are no reliable walk-in hours, should opening-hours schema be suppressed?
4. Which author, tag, category, event, conference, presentation, training and team archives are intended to rank as standalone resources?
5. Which forms and external platforms represent completed counselling inquiries, training registrations and donations, and who can configure cross-domain measurement?
6. Which counsellors or faculty members can review and be named on Bowen theory, counselling, crisis and professional-training content?
7. Which existing backlinks and external listings still point to legacy URLs, especially contact, donation, newsletter and removed article paths?
8. Does the hosting plan provide automated offsite backups, persistent object caching, opcode cache, WAF/security controls and a documented restore process?

Caveats and Assumptions

Documenting technical boundaries and data reliance ensures stakeholders understand audit limitations. Explicit assumptions safeguard against misinterpreting third-party search estimates and establish proper expectations for performance outcomes.

- This is a snapshot based on the accessible website and accounts on the audit date. Search demand, rankings, plugin versions, crawl counts and analytics continue to change.
- Semrush traffic, authority, AI mentions, backlink and listing figures are third-party estimates. Search Console and GA4 are the first-party sources for visibility and behaviour.

- The Semrush crawl covered 169 of a 1,000-page allowance with mobile rendering and JavaScript enabled. Unlinked, blocked, parameterized or newly published URLs may be absent.
- No server logs, hosting control panel, Google Business Profile, consent-management configuration, email-delivery logs or external form/payment analytics were reviewed.
- The SEO and AEO scores are directional rubrics for prioritization. They do not forecast rankings, traffic, citations, counselling outcomes or revenue.
- Draft page copy must be reviewed for factual accuracy, professional standards, accessibility, privacy, crisis-language requirements and brand voice before publication.
- No website, plugin, analytics or account changes were made during this audit.

Primary guidance and benchmark documents

Adhering to official search engine guidelines and web standards guarantees compliance with technical best practices. Following benchmark documentation protects the site from algorithmic penalties and aligns implementation with industry standards.

- [Google: Optimizing for generative AI features](#)
- [Google: Title links in search results](#)
- [Google: Meta descriptions and snippets](#)
- [Google: Search appearance and structured data](#)
- [Google Analytics: About key events](#)
- [OpenAI: Publishers and Developers FAQ](#)
- [Yoast: Local SEO configuration guide](#)
- [Yoast: Organization schema for your business](#)
- [W3C: Link purpose, headings and image alternatives](#)
- [WordPress.org: Simple History activity-log plugin](#)